

RRB NTPC Advanced Practice Paper

Ancient Indian History — Comprehensive Syllabus Set 3 (10 High-Yield Questions)

1. Which Harappan site displays a unique structural configuration where the citadel and lower town are not separate, but the entire settlement is surrounded by a single defensive wall?

- A) Chanhudaro
- B) Surkotada
- C) Banawali
- D) Kot Diji

Correct Answer: B) Surkotada

Detailed Explanation: Surkotada (Gujarat) features a unified fortified layout split internally into a citadel and a residential zone, alongside rare stone-rubble masonry.

2. In the evolutionary structure of ancient Indian economy, the silver punch-marked coins ('Karshapana') commonly featured symbols like the sun and tree-in-railing. Which historical authority systematized their issuance on a massive scale?

- A) Nanda Dynasty
- B) Mauryan Empire
- C) Indo-Greeks
- D) Kushanas

Correct Answer: B) Mauryan Empire

Detailed Explanation: While punch-marked coins existed during the Mahajanapada era, the Mauryan state regulated and standardized their weights and symbols via the Rupadarshaka (currency inspector).

3. The unique text 'Junagadh Inscription' of Skandagupta records structural engineering works on the Sudarshana Lake dam. Which local governor ('Gopta') executed these crucial repairs during his reign?

- A) Chakrapalita
- B) Parnadatta
- C) Tusaspha
- D) Radhagupta

Correct Answer: B) Parnadatta

Detailed Explanation: Parnadatta was appointed governor of Saurashtra by Skandagupta, and his son Chakrapalita carried out the actual structural reconstruction of the burst dam.

4. The dynamic 7th-century ruler Harshavardhana was a prolific author. Which combination includes the three Sanskrit plays composed explicitly by Harsha himself?

- A) Ratnavali, Priyadarsika, Nagananda
- B) Malavikagnimitram, Mudrarakshasa, Nagananda
- C) Kadambari, Harshacharita, Ratnavali
- D) Priyadarsika, Karpuramanjari, Nagananda

Correct Answer: A) Ratnavali, Priyadarsika, Nagananda

Detailed Explanation: Harsha wrote the structural dramas Ratnavali, Priyadarsika, and the Buddhist-themed Nagananda. Kadambari and Harshacharita were written by his court poet Banabhatta.

5. The unique corporate structural bodies called 'Shrenis' acted as banks, judiciaries, and manufacturing guilds. Which ancient legal code or text outlines that the king must respect and uphold the laws of the Shreni?

- A) Rigveda
- B) Manusmriti
- C) Arthashastra
- D) Naradasmriti

Correct Answer: B) Manusmriti

Detailed Explanation: Manusmriti and Naradasmriti emphasize the autonomy of guilds, stating that 'Shreni-dharma' (guild laws) must be enforced and protected by the monarch.

6. The great Mauryan ruler Ashoka set up major rock edicts at strategic borders. Which script was utilized for the Ashokan inscriptions located at Shahbazgarhi and Mansehra in the northwest?

- A) Brahmi
- B) Kharosthi
- C) Aramaic
- D) Greek

Correct Answer: B) Kharosthi

Detailed Explanation: The northwestern edicts were written in the local Kharosthi script (derived from Aramaic, written from right to left) to ensure readability for the border populations.

7. The dynamic philosophical assembly organized by Harsha at Kannauj was designed to popularize the doctrines of which specific religious line?

- A) Hinayana Buddhism
- B) Mahayana Buddhism
- C) Digambara Jainism
- D) Pasupata Shaivism

Correct Answer: B) Mahayana Buddhism

Detailed Explanation: The Kannauj Assembly (643 CE) was presided over by Xuanzang and served as a major forum to showcase the superiority of Mahayana Buddhist tenets.

8. Which ancient Indian text provides a structural, highly technical manual on ancient architecture, town planning, iconometry, and civil engineering?

- A) Sulvasutras
- B) Mayamata / Samarangana Sutradhara
- C) Charaka Samhita
- D) Amarakosha

Correct Answer: B) Mayamata / Samarangana Sutradhara

Detailed Explanation: Mayamata and Samarangana Sutradhara are structural Vastu Shastra manuals detailing architectural metrics. Sulvasutras deal with geometric altar measurements.

9. The historical battle fought in 326 BCE on the banks of the Hydaspes River witnessed Alexander facing King Porus. Which modern Punjabi river corresponds to the ancient Hydaspes?

- A) Jhelum
- B) Chenab
- C) Ravi
- D) Beas

Correct Answer: A) Jhelum

Detailed Explanation: Hydaspes is the classical Greek name for the Jhelum River, where the fierce tactical standoff between Macedonian and Paurava forces occurred.

10. The major ancient kingdom of Gandhara, listed among the 16 Mahajanapadas, was structurally centered around which international hub of trade and academic study?

- A) Champa
- B) Taxila
- C) Viratanagara
- D) Ujjain

Correct Answer: B) Taxila

Detailed Explanation: Taxila was the capital of Gandhara and an exceptional node for long-distance trade routes connecting India with Central Asia, evolving into a premium university center.